

of this growth. The future of AR tech looks bright. The primary reason for this - the two biggest mobile ecosystems iOS and Android have both introduced development kits for AR.

Apple's ARKit and Google's ARCore have taken the tech industry by storm and have enabled everyone from newbies to novices with the means to bring AR apps to the mass market. The simplicity of ARKit and ARCore means that developers can work with it even if they do not really understand the science behind AR.

AR is far from being a new concept. Regardless when the concept was floated around almost 2 decades ago, the computational power and resources needed to make it happen would have involved a lot of bulky gear as well as would have been far from being cost effective. Now that we have reached the point where devices have everything from sensors, portability, computing power - AR has become a practical solution. In fact, it might be the answer to making everyday living simpler and more efficient.

Inception of ARKit and ARCore

Tech giants, Apple and Google, have always been (and might forever be) in a face off to win the title of 'No. 1' in the field of new and pathbreaking technologies especially on their respective OS platforms. In current times, both these mega companies seem to be putting the spotlight on AR and are keen on riding the wave of success by expanding the levels of access and utility of AR in the consumer market.

AR has helped developers and users alike merge and blend their physical as well as digital environment. With the release of ARCore for Android and ARKit for iOS, users were privy to a first hand experience of objects that are 'unreal' or digitally superimposed on their physical environment. Imagine seeing a dinosaur in your front yard or a superhero at your work desk. ARKit was the first to be announced during the WWDC17 (Worldwide Developers' Conference 2017). Google, not wanting to be left far behind, announced the launch of ARCore a few hours later.

The first real mass-level success story of AR could arguably be the 2016 game PokemonGo. The popularity amassed by the game made AR an everyday occurrence in the lives of thousands around the globe. Apple, at this juncture, decided to finally announce its decision to make AR available for its smartphone devices via the ARKit. Within hours of this announcement came a counter-announcement of sorts from Google about their latest offering - ARCore.